Open a terminal window and navigate to the root folder of the Natter API project. Then run the following command to generate a keystore with a 256-bit HMAC key:

```
keytool -genseckey -keyalg HmacSHA256 -keysize 256 \    #A
    -alias hmac-key -keystore keystore.p12 \
    -storetype PKCS12 \    #B
    -storepass changeit    #C
```

#A Generate a 256-bit key for HMAC-SHA256
#B Store it in a PKCS#12 keystore
#C Set a password for the keystore – ideally better than this one!

You can the load the keystore in your main method and then extract the key to pass to the `HmacTokenStore`. Rather than hard-code the keystore password in the source code, where it is accessible to anyone who can access the source code, you can pass it in from a system property or environment variable. This ensures that the developers writing the API do not know the password used for the production environment. The password can then be used to unlock the keystore and to access the key itself.[6] After you have loaded the key, you can then create the `HmacKeyStore` instance, as shown in listing 5.12. Open Main.java in your editor and find the lines that construct the `DatabaseTokenStore` and `TokenController`. Update them to match the listing.

Listing 5.12 Loading the HMAC key

```
var keyPassword = System.getProperty("keystore.password",
#A
        "changeit").toCharArray();    #A
```